

Antonio Carmagnani

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Dear Hiring Team at Deloitte,

I trained as an architect, and the interest that has run alongside that from the beginning is data - using it to understand what has been built and what could be built better. That is what took me from architecture practice into feasibility and analysis, and then to a Master's Degree in Architecture Computation at The Royal Danish Academy, a programme built around using data and technology to improve the decisions made in real estate and construction. The through line has been consistent, which is that I would rather build the analytical tool that answers a question than argue the question without one. Deloitte's Finance Transformation team does that inside the CFO function, where more than 350 consultants in Denmark rebuild how finance functions operate, report and forecast rather than only advising on what the numbers say.

At OSPA I produced multiple feasibility studies for residential and mixed-use developments across Brazil and the United States, sizing investment and return for each candidate site against buildable area, unit mix, price per square metre and parking, while reading the municipal master plan and land-use law to establish how much development potential the site actually carried. What that work taught me is that the number a client commits capital against is only as good as the regulatory reading underneath it, and that the two have to be produced together rather than in sequence. That habit of producing a figure alongside the constraints it rests on is the finance craftsmanship this programme sets out to build, and it is where I would start from rather than arrive at.

At Isay Weinfeld Architects I wrote a Grasshopper plugin in Python that generates bespoke staircases directly from a floor plan, which took a task that had run to several days down to roughly twenty minutes and made a far wider range of geometry testable within a project timeline. Building it was the smaller half of the work - the rest was sitting with the colleagues who had been doing it by hand to establish what they actually needed, presenting the tool in a studio workshop, and supporting its adoption across more than ten projects afterwards, which taught me that a tool nobody trusts enough to use has not been finished. Transforming a finance function is the same problem at a larger scale, since a process only improves once the people running it have been convinced to work the new way.

Deloitte puts an analyst across operational finance, performance management and system implementations in the first years rather than in one discipline, which is the fastest way I can think of to learn the CFO domain properly. That is where I want to keep doing the work I find most worthwhile, which is turning large and awkward bodies of data into something a business can decide on.

Best,

Antonio Carmagnani